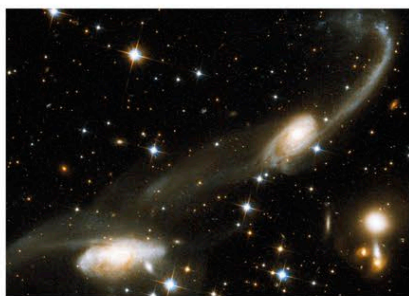


TRIANGULUM AUSTRALE

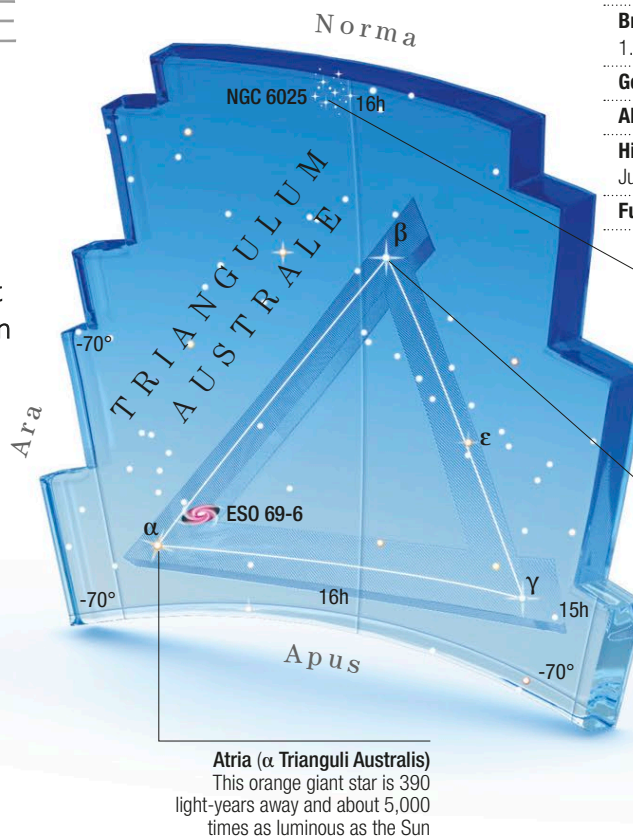
THE SOUTHERN TRIANGLE

A SMALL CONSTELLATION DEVISED BY LINKING THREE BRIGHT STARS, TRIANGULUM AUSTRALE MAKES A DISTINCTIVE PATTERN AND IS CROSSED BY A STAR-RICH REGION OF THE MILKY WAY.

This bright triangle of stars is easy to spot to the southeast of Centaurus. It's not certain who devised the constellation but it was first recorded in Johann Bayer's star atlas, *Uranometria*, in 1603. Although crossed by the Milky Way, Triangulum Australe has little of interest to amateur astronomers, except star cluster NGC 6025.



◀ **ESO 69-6**
Long tails sweep out from each of the galaxies in this interacting pair, together known as ESO 69-6. The tails are gas and stars that have been ripped out of the outer regions of the galaxies. The galaxies are about 650 million light-years from Earth.



KEY DATA

Size ranking	83
Brightest stars	Alpha (α) 1.9, Beta (β) 2.8
Genitive	Trianguli Australis
Abbreviation	TrA
Highest in sky at 10pm	June–July
Fully visible	19°N–90°S



CHART 2

NGC 6025

An open cluster of stars of magnitude 5.1 and visible to the naked eye, but best seen through binoculars

Beta (β) Trianguli Australis

A white main-sequence star, twice the Sun's width and 40 light-years from Earth. It is surrounded by a disk of dust debris

Atria (α Trianguli Australis)
This orange giant star is 390 light-years away and about 5,000 times as luminous as the Sun

TELESCOPIUM

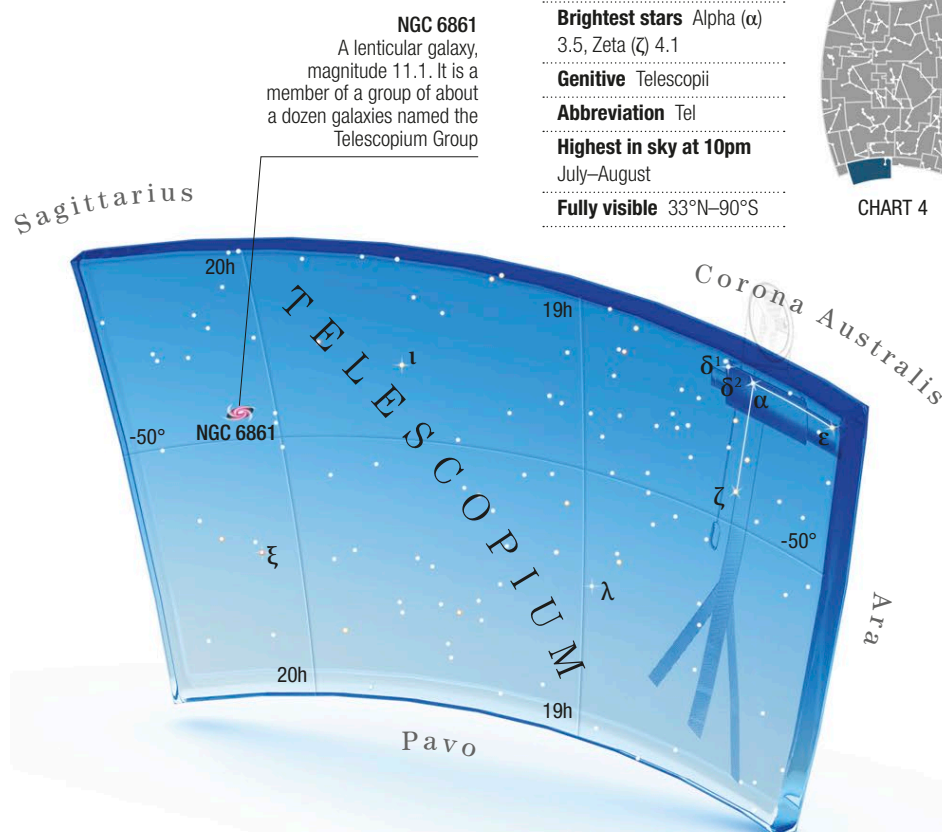
THE TELESCOPE

THIS IS A FAINT AND OBSCURE CONSTELLATION, INTRODUCED TO THE SOUTHERN SKY IN THE 1750s. TELESCOPIUM IS SOUTH OF THE DISTINCTIVE SAGITTARIUS AND CORONA AUSTRALIS.

One of the least recognizable constellations, Telescopium's pattern is drawn around a right angle of linked stars tucked into a corner of the constellation's sky area. It was devised by Frenchman Nicolas Louis de Lacaille, using additional stars from surrounding constellations. These have been returned, leaving Telescopium in its present state.

▷ NGC 6861

This is a lenticular galaxy whose disk is tilted to our line of sight. Dark bands within the disk are the result of large clouds of dust particles obscuring the light from more distant stars.



KEY DATA

Size ranking	57
Brightest stars	Alpha (α) 3.5, Zeta (ζ) 4.1
Genitive	Telescopii
Abbreviation	Tel
Highest in sky at 10pm	July–August
Fully visible	33°N–90°S

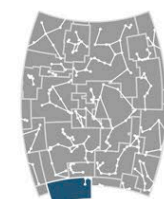


CHART 4

NGC 6861
A lenticular galaxy, magnitude 11.1. It is a member of a group of about a dozen galaxies named the Telescopium Group